Portland Mission Team Training

Training adapted and prepared by Luke Johnston using an inherited mission-team training framework; original source credits retained. Based on a mission-team training template credited to Jay Baughman.

Complete available instructional text; travel administration and the security appendix omitted. The source plan includes five formal training meetings and a sixth family gathering.

Full teaching files

encouragement verses	*2 pages*
M03 Portland Complete Available Teaching Text	*9 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

Verses for Encouragement

Rom. 1:16 – *For I am not ashamed of the gospel of Christ: for it is the power of God unto salvation to every one that believeth; to the Jew first, and also to the Greek.*

Ezek. 3:17-19 –*Son of man, I have made thee a watchman unto the house of Israel: therefore hear the word at my mouth, and give them warning from me. When I say unto the wicked, Thou shalt surely die; and thou givest him not warning, nor speakest to warn the wicked from his wicked way, to save his life; the same wicked man shall die in his iniquity; but his blood will I require at thine hand.*

Yet if thou warn the wicked, and he turn not from his wickedness, nor from his wicked way, he shall die in his iniquity; but thou hast delivered thy soul.

Isa. 55:11 – *So shall my word be that goeth forth out of my mouth: it shall not return unto me void, but it shall accomplish that which I please, and it shall prosper in the thing whereto I sent it.*

2 Tim. 4:2 – *Preach the word; be instant in season, out of season; reprove, rebuke, exhort with all longsuffering and doctrine.*

1 Cor. 15:58 – *Therefore, my beloved brethren, be ye stedfast, unmoveable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, forasmuch as ye know that your labour is not in vain in the Lord.*

Prov. 11:30 – *The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life; and he that winneth souls is wise.*

Matt. 5:16 – *Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven.*

John 15:5 – *I am the vine, ye are the branches: He that abideth in me, and I in him, the same bringeth forth much fruit: for without me ye can do nothing.*

1 Thess. 2:4 – *But as we were allowed of God to be put in trust with the gospel, even so we speak; not as pleasing men, but God, which trieth our hearts.*

Gal. 6:9 – *And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not.*

Matt. 28:19–20 – *Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost: Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you: and, lo, I am with you alway, even unto the end of the world. Amen.*

2 Cor. 5:20 – *Now then we are ambassadors for Christ, as though God did beseech you by us: we pray you in Christ's stead, be ye reconciled to God.*

Acts 4:31 – *And when they had prayed, the place was shaken where they were assembled together; and they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and they spake the word of God with boldness.*

1 Corinthians 9:16- *For though I preach the gospel, I have nothing to glory of: for necessity is laid upon me; yea, woe is unto me, if I preach not the gospel!*

Eph. 6:19 – *And for me, that utterance may be given unto me, that I may open my mouth boldly, to make known the mystery of the gospel,*

Col. 4:3 – *Withal praying also for us, that God would open unto us a door of utterance, to speak the mystery of Christ, for which I am also in bonds:*

Mark 16:15 – *And he said unto them, Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature.*

Rom. 10:14 – *How then shall they call on him in whom they have not believed? and how shall they believe in him of whom they have not heard? and how shall they hear without a preacher?*

Jer. 20:9 – *Then I said, I will not make mention of him, nor speak any more in his name. But his word was in mine heart as a burning fire shut up in my bones, and I was weary with forbearing, and I could not stay.*

Luke 14:23 – *And the lord said unto the servant, Go out into the highways and hedges, and compel them to come in, that my house may be filled.*

Ps. 27:1 – *The Lord is my light and my salvation; whom shall I fear? the Lord is the strength of my life; of whom shall I be afraid?*

Portland Mission Team Training

Complete available teaching text with administration omitted

This portfolio edition contains the available instructional text from the Portland mission teacher manual: the training sequence, participant devotions, prayer, cultural preparation, gospel instruction, conversation practice, Scripture assignments, and team preparation. Travel arrangements, costs, contacts, and the travel security appendix have been omitted.

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Six week training sequence

Week 1 Prayer for Portland, culture of Portland, and defining the gospel.

Week 2 Watchmen chapters 1–3; the A.S.K. method; promoting good conversations.

Week 3 Watchmen chapters 4–6; anticipating encounters; practice with the A.S.K. method.

Week 4 Watchmen chapters 7–9; practice with the A.S.K. method.

Week 5 Watchmen chapters 10–14; continued A.S.K. practice and team preparation.

Week 6 Family cookout and team fellowship. The source schedule does not list an additional formal lesson for this session.

The original plan also includes participant devotions: share a verse or passage that encourages, motivates, and inspires service, followed by devotion and prayer time. Watchmen is retained as the reading label used in the source schedule.

Devotion Ideas

Share a verse/passage that really encourages you in the work of the Lord and tell why it encourages, motivates, and inspires you. We will have time to meet together at the beginning of each day for this devotion and prayer time.

Prayer Requests For Portland Gospel Church

1. Pray for Portland Gospel Church as they are on the streets doing the work.

Pray for their open doors

Pray for people to respond, surrender, and join the church/discipleship

2. Pray for their disciples to stand strong and continue to grow

3. Pray that they will make new disciples

5. Pray for our team to be unified and as prepared as we can be!

Pray for our open doors and appointments to be from God

Pray for our distractions to be minimal and our focus to remain strong

Culture Of Portland Notes

Understanding Portland's Culture for Evangelism

Portland is known for its progressive, independent, and countercultural spirit. The city has a reputation for being highly secular, socially liberal, and environmentally conscious. Understanding all of this will only help you in your gospel conversations you will have.

1. Demographics and General Worldview

• Highly Secular Population – Portland is one of the most unchurched cities in America. Many people identify as "spiritual but not religious" or hold to atheism, agnosticism, or alternative spiritualities (New Age, Wicca, Eastern religions)

• Young & Progressive– The city attracts young professionals, artists, and activists. Many Portlanders are passionate about social justice, environmentalism, and LGBTQ+ rights

• DIY and Independent Thinking – Portland's culture values individualism, anti-corporate sentiment, and personal freedom. This can make them resistant to authority, tradition, or absolute truth

• Homelessness and Drug Addiction – Portland has one of the largest populations of homeless individuals, many of whom struggle with drug addiction, mental illness, and poverty

2. The Religious and Spiritual Climate

• Post-Christian and Anti-Church Sentiment – Many Portlanders have a negative view of organized religion, particularly Christianity. To them it is associated with hypocrisy, old thinking, conservatism, and in many ways what is wrong with the world

• New Age and Mysticism – While many reject Christianity, there is an interest in mysticism, astrology, tarot, and alternative spirituality

• Liberal Theologies and Universalism – Some churches in Portland embrace a progressive, universalist approach to Christianity. They emphasize social justice over doctrine and rejecting traditional views of sin, judgment, and salvation

3. Cultural Priorities and Beliefs

• Tolerance and Inclusivity – Portland places a high value on acceptance of all lifestyles, beliefs, and identities. The idea that Jesus is the only way to salvation is seen as narrow minded or even offensive

• Environmentalism and Sustainability – Many residents view caring for the environment as a major moral issue, sometimes with religious devotion

• Anti-Authority and Anti-Corporate – Portlanders tend to distrust large institutions, including government, corporations, and churches. They favor grassroots movements, local businesses, and alternative lifestyles (against the grain/progressively minded)

• Justice and Activism – Issues like racial justice, LGBTQ+ rights, feminism, and economic equality dominate much of the cultural and political discourse

4. Effective Evangelism Strategies with Culture in Mind

A. Engaging Intellectuals and Skeptics

• Ask questions instead of just preaching – Instead of immediately stating biblical truths, ask “What do you think happens after death?” or “Do you think objective morality exists?”

• Use reason – Many are skeptical of the Bible, so be prepared to discuss historical evidence for Christ, the reliability of Scripture, and moral arguments for God’s existence

This is NOT necessary to know to share the gospel or reach people effectively. The power is in the GOSPEL (Rom. 1:16). Being prepared for your encounters through prayer and a consistent walk with the Lord is invaluable.

However, some people will respond well to any answers you can give them in this area (Isaiah 1:18; Acts 17:2-4; 18:4; 1 Pet. 3:15).

• Be ready for anti-Christian objections – Expect challenges about the problem of evil, Christianity’s role in history, and accusations of intolerance.

B. Engaging the “Spiritually Curious”

• Speak about Jesus rather than ‘Christianity’ – Many reject the institutional church but have never truly encountered Jesus. Religion vs Relationship.

• Share testimonies – Personal stories of how God has impacted your life can be more effective than doctrinal arguments (2 Cor. 3:2-3).

C. Evangelizing to Activists

• Avoid political debates – Stick to Jesus and the Gospel, not cultural wars or conservative vs. liberal arguments. Do not even entertain political debates. Politics is the poor man’s religion. It is not worth the possibility of it interfering with their opportunity to hear the gospel.

• Gently challenge their worldview – Many see morality as relative. Ask: “Where do you think justice comes from? If there’s no God, why does right and wrong matter?”

5. Overcoming Resistance

• On RARE occasions, people may passionately disagree with you; or even more rare, they may be angry with you. Do not let this sidetrack you from the mission.

Firstly, it is a rare occurrence. It likely won’t happen to you.

Secondly, we are to expect persecution as believers who live godly in boldly sharing the gospel (2 Tim. 3:12)

Thirdly, this may in fact show a deep-down working of God in their hearts. Some of the people who show the most outward rejection are in fact battling deep down against God pricking their hearts (Acts 9:5; 26:14)

The Gospel

1. Defining the gospel. What exactly is it?

The clearest definition – 1 Corinthians 15:1-4

Where do we start with it?

Key elements

God became a man in the form of Jesus Christ

Jesus lived a perfect, sinless life

Jesus laid His life down in the stead of sinful man – John 1:29; Rom. 3:25; 1 John 4:10.

He then rose again from the dead three days later conquering sin, the grave, and hell for the sinner.

Jesus must be recognized and received by man, trusting in Jesus Christ alone, to be redeemed by God – John 1:12

2. Our obedience to give the gospel

Romans 1:16, 10:15, 15:16; 1 Cor. 1:17-18, 9:16; 2 Cor. 4:3-4; Gal. 1:8-9, 11; Eph. 1:13, 6:19; Php 1:12; 1 Thess. 2:4, 8; 2 Thess. 1:8; 1 Tim. 1:11; Heb. 4:2.

The gospel is the power of God and we must trust in the authority of God that the gospel will do its work.

The ASK method

Our conversations are exactly that. Conversations; not presentations. Each person you meet will have a different opinion, even if they share the same denomination. Use where they are at to best minister to them.

A Ask Questions

Asking questions is good for provoking thought in people. Jesus often asked questions for this very reason. Realistically, Jesus never had to ask questions to learn more about people because he knew everything about them. Jesus asked questions so often because he was provoking thought into the hearts of the listeners. (Matt. 16:13-16; John 21:15-17; Matt. 21:24-27)

ASK permission to begin a conversation… “Can I ask you a question?”

ASK their opinion… “Who do you believe Jesus was/is?” – Matt. 16:13-15; John 10:7-9, 14:6.

We can debate/argue many foolish questions with them, but what they believe about Jesus will be what matters most – Matt. 12:19; 2 Tim. 2:23-26.

Respond to their answers respectfully and kindly… “That’s really interesting” or “I really appreciate your opinion” or “Where did you learn that?”

As we continue into “S” and “K”…we will continue to ask questions.

Key Questions

Who do you believe Jesus is/was?

If you died tonight, where would you go AND why?

Do you believe in God? Heaven/Hell?

Do you go to church anywhere?

Do you have any kind of spiritual belief?

If what you believe were not true, would you want to know it?

At the close of the conversation based on what we just discussed

Are you a sinner?

Do you want forgiveness for your sins?

Do you believe that Jesus was God and died on the cross and rose again for YOUR SINS?

Are you willing to surrender your life to Jesus Christ and ask him to save you?

S Share the Gospel

This cannot be overstated. This is our number one goal when we are out witnessing. All these things we will go over are great tools when time allows for them, but sharing the gospel must be done at all costs! God will take care of the rest if we are faithful to do this! (Rom. 1:16; Phil.1:14-18; Psalm 40:9-10; 71:15-16; 119:46; Rom. 10:17; 1 Cor. 2:4; 9:16; Jer. 20:7-9)

Next we teach them what the Bible says about Jesus…the Gospel – Matt. 28:19a.

Teach the gospel in the way in which you are comfortable or the situation dictates.

Ways to Give the Gospel

Good Test

Go through the law (10 commandments) and show them the penalty of their sin and the price Jesus paid for it (Romans 3:23; 6:23; 10:9-10,13)

Problem Solution

Problem- We are sinful, (Rom 3:23; Ecc. 7:20; Gal. 3:22; 1 John 1:8-10; Rom. 5:12; Rom. 6:23a) but God is Holy, which means he must judge sin righteously, and also he cannot be in the presence of sin (Habb. 1:13; Psalm 5:4-5; 11:4-7; 34:15-16; 1 Pet. 1:15-16)

Solution- God became a man in the form of Jesus Christ, and lived a perfect and holy life. Jesus lived for about 33 years and allowed his creation to crucify him on a cross so he could take the punishment for sin for all men. (John 3:16-19; Rom. 6:23; 10:9-10, 13; Eph. 2:8-9)

Romans Road

Romans 3:23 (We have all sinned but God is perfect)

Romans 6:23 (the price for our sin is death- eternal death in hell seperated from God), BUT Jesus paid for this for you so you don't have to

Romans 10:9,13 (The way to receive Jesus gift of salvation and the price he paid for your sin is to believe and pray to God to receive this gift)

Testimony

You can give your personal testimony in any gospel conversation and often times it could be very helpful. Your testimony is a good tool, but remember the POWER is in the word of God/the Gospel. Giving your testimony will always need to include the word of God and a clear gospel from the Bible

This is a good time to make this point as well: the power is in the word of God not your words, arguments, reasoning, etc.. memorize and share the word of God in your conversations! (1 Thess. 2:13)

Then ASK them for a response “What do you think about that?” or “Does that make sense to you?” or “Have you ever heard anything like that before?”

Continue the conversation by responding to their responses.

We are looking to share the gospel with as many people as we can…that’s the command and where the power of God lies – Mark 16:15.

We are looking for receptive people that God brings our way – John 5:17.

Lead them to pray to receive Christ if they are ready!

Practice and be ready for how you might lead them to pray to receive Christ.

When we are witnessing to someone, you will have to get a feel for the conversation. If you have time, take time. If you can tell they are ready to go, then ask if you can share what you wanted to when you asked them who Jesus is to them, and then hand them a tract. At the very least, try to leave them with a tract and ask them to read it and consider what it says. DO NOT BE AFRAID TO STEER CONVERSATIONS. People want to talk about these things and they will not think twice about sharing what they think with you, so do not be afraid to share with them.

K Keep the Conversation Going

“We do not want to give up on any conversation until we have to.” – Pastor Thomas Harding

If you’ve had a good conversation (they get saved…or just a great, interactive conversation), ASK if they’d like to continue the discussion over coffee or whatever method Portland Gospel Church gives us.

“We don’t just want to throw seeds to the wind. Seek for a second encounter”

Portland Gospel Church is a disciple-making church. Their role once we leave will be to nurture any fruit so that it might remain – John 15:8, 16; Matt. 28:19b.

Qualities that promote good conversations

1. Prepare

Pray- Ask God to give you boldness (Acts 4:29), wisdom (James 1:5), and divine appointments (Eph. 6:19; Col. 4:3)

Trust God with the results- Your job is to share, not convert. You can't fail if you share your faith. You fail only if you don't share it.

2. Make eye contact

Do not be afraid of them – 2 Tim. 1:7; Jer. 1:6-10, 17.

If God did not give us the fear we are feeling, then it's from our flesh or the devil.

3. Listen, and use their names

Using their names makes it personal and lets them know you care about them personally.

Use tricks to help you remember.

4. Listen and affirm them as individuals with souls – 2 Pet. 3:9; Col. 1:28-29.

If we are going to interrupt their day to A.S.K. them about Jesus, they expect to be heard.

It is SO IMPORTANT that they see we will genuinely listen, care, and be interested in them.

The balance is for us to be more interested in communicating Jesus to them.

Don't argue. Just say, "Hmm," and listen. (William Fay calls this the "hmm principle" in his book "Sharing Jesus Without Fear)

It is a way to actively engage with what they are saying and it matters more than you'd think

5. Speak in a tone that is conducive to a conversation – Pr. 15:1.

Remember, our gospel presentations are a conversation. Each will ebb and flow a little differently.

Seek to project softly and kindly…yet be bold, confident, and persuasive – 1 Thess. 2:7.

Consider that your posture and countenance will speak to them as importantly as your words – Ps. 4:6.

A quote regarding posture – "Your uplook determines your outlook"

A quote regarding tone – "I could hear your voice, but not your words"

6. Be honest and put yourself out there with each conversation – 2 Cor. 4:1-10

Work hard for the Lord believing each swing you take might be a homerun – 1 Thess. 2:8

Make sure, make sure, make sure that your motivations are right each day – 1 Thess. 2:1-6

7. Remember two important factors as you speak

The Bible describes those who don't know God as lost and blind, yet not far from God – 2 Cor. 4:3; Matt. 15:14; Is. 42:7; Acts 17:27-28.

Consider each person you meet as a divine appointment. We should be thinking…who did God arrange for me to speak to today? – Acts 8:26-39

Homework: Before our trip…look up, read, and write out the following verses about the gospel and include it in your binder for review and encouragement:

Romans 1:16, 10:15, 15:16; 1 Cor. 1:17-18, 9:16; 15:1-4; 2 Cor. 4:3-4; Gal. 1:8-9, 11; Eph. 1:13, 6:19; Php 1:12; 1 Thess. 2:4, 8; 2 Thess. 1:8; 1 Tim. 1:11; Heb. 4:2.

Anticipating our Encounters

When we ask: Who do you believe Jesus was? Transition from this response…

I don't believe He ever existed

I'm an atheist

Science explains everything…I believe in science

He was just a man like us

I believe He was God's son

Will this be quick?

When we ask: What do you think about that (after the gospel)? How would you respond?

How can you believe there's only one way that is right?

I already go to church.

I've been baptized

I am Muslim

You don't believe in creation…do you?

I'm an atheist

I believe we evolved and that there is no God

I'm a good person

The Bible was just written by man

What about dinosaurs?

That's good for some people, but that's not what I believe.

Good questions to ask additional

Do you have a spiritual background?

Have you ever read the Bible?

Biggest Issue we ll likely encounter

People are in too big of a hurry…and don't want to be bothered – I'm alright mate!

Seven team preparation principles

Thing #1:We need to operate as a team

Operating as a team involves two important things:

To operate as a team, we must all be likeminded about our mission and purpose

To operate as a team, we must say the same things..

Thing #2:We need to diligently prepare for our mission

Prayer

Training

Walk with the Lord

Encouragement

Thing #3:We need to understand that some will need to be in charge of certain matters

Thing #4:We will for sure have fun, but there can be no practical jokes

Practical jokes are neither practical nor funny

Thing #5:We will leave arrogance at home; there is no place for it on this trip

Q: What will destroy team unity faster than anything else?

A: Someone seeking preeminence; selfishness; arrogance

Thing #6:We plan on being opposed and attacked

The physical factor:

The emotional factor:

Thing #7:We will travel by a common creed…

Motto: We are the “no excuses” short-term missionary team

Attitude: No problem… be flexible